

EDUCATION

The Chinese University of Hong Kong & Northwestern University	Hong Kong & Evanston, IL
Dual Master's Degree Program	
– M.Sc. in Applied Economics, CUHK	2026–2027
– M.Sc. in Social and Economic Policy, Northwestern University	2027–2028
Wuhan University	Wuhan, China
Bachelor in Law with Specialization in PPE (Philosophy, Politics and Economics)	2022–2026
GPA:3.74/ 4.00	

RESEARCH INTEREST

- Microeconomics Theory (Matching & Market Design)
- Political Economy
- Industrial Organization

WORKING PAPER

1. Yao Cheng, Jingsheng Yu, and **Ling Zheng**, “Efficient Major Transition Exchange under Distributional and Dual Priority-respecting Constraints,” *arXiv:2504.12727 [econ.TH]* Under Review at **GEB**.

Abstract: Many real matching markets encounter distributional and fairness constraints. Motivated by the Chinese Major Transition Program (CMT), this paper studies the design of exchange mechanisms within a fresh framework of both distributional and dual priority-respecting constraints. Specifically, each student has an initial assigned major and applies to transfer to a more desirable one. A student can successfully transfer majors only if they obtain eligibility from both their initial major and applied major. Each major has a dual priority: a strict priority over current students who wish to transfer out and a strict priority over students from other majors who wish to transfer in. Additionally, each major faces a ceiling constraint and a floor constraint to regulate student distribution. We show that the existing mechanism of CMT may result in inefficiencies, and propose two mechanisms that can match students to majors in an efficient way, while respecting each major’s distributional constraints and dual priority.

EXPERIENCE

- RA for Prof. Guojun He (HKU Business School) 2026.5 – Present
- RA for Prof. Robin Burgess (LSE) & John Van Reenen (LSE and MIT) 2026.5 – Present
 - Funded by LSE STICERD.
- RA for Prof. Yuxiao Hu (SJTU) 2026.1 – Present
- RA for Prof. Rufei Guo (WHU) 2024.11 – 2025.3

PROJECT

College Students' Innovative Entrepreneurial Training Plan Program	Hubei Province
Supervisor: Prof.Tianding Zhang	2023.8-2024.5
- Title: Extreme risk spillovers from investor sentiment to crude oil market - Conducted a literature review on articles and actively discussed on the paper - Cleaned and preprocessed the raw data and applied NLP techniques to obtain text similarity data	

SELECTED CORE COURSES

- **Mathematics:** Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability and Statics, Dynamic Optimization etc.
- **Economics:** Advanced Microeconomic Theory, Industrial Organization, Game Theory etc.
- **Political Science:** Comparative Politics, Chinese Politics etc.

SKILLS

- **Python:**Proficiency
- **L^AT_EX:** Proficiency
- **R:** Intermediate
- **Stata:** Intermediate

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Fluency (CET6: 618; Toefl: 104)
- **Chinese:** Native

PRESENTATION

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| • Impromptu CCBEF-IES Workshop | May, 2025 |
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HONORS & AWARDS

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| • Honored Graduate Student | 2026 |
| • Provincial-Level Completion, National College Students' Innovation and Entrepreneurship Training Program | 2024 |
| • Hongyi College Outstanding Student Staff | 2022 |